Ahmad Abdul-Jawad *Mahmoud*

FOUNDER & CTO, BURAQ / FOUNDING ENGINEER / TECHNICAL LEAD

CAIRO → RIYADH · BUILDS THE COMPANY AND ITS FIRST VERSION



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★ SEE THE LIVE INTERACTIVE EDITION ↗

→ BURAQ — BURAQSPORT.COM ↗

I founded **Buraq** and built it myself. Since March 2026 I have been Founder & CTO of an Egyptian ride-hailing platform (buraqsport.com): a Next.js 15 / PostgreSQL / Redis backend, a 29-screen operations console, rider and captain apps on iOS and Android, and the public web app now live — **3,100+ commits across nine repositories**, every one of them mine. Around the code I formed the company, priced the product from 626 observed competitor fares, and wrote the business model and go-live plan. Before that I spent **12+ years** in iOS and **seven of them leading** the engineering teams that shipped products used by 20k+ restaurants — so I build for the day the second engineer arrives.

12+	9	10k+	20k+
YEARS OF APP ENGINEERING	ROYAL MAIL APPS LED	AUTOMATED TESTS ACROSS THE CODEBASE	BUSINESSES SERVED BY THE 2ND LEAD

§ 01 Zero to One

01 — DEEP FROM NOTHING

Empty repo to launch-ready platform

I take the first version all the way myself — data model, API, the console, the apps. That's how a **22-module** backend (**trip state machine, scored dispatch** over a Redis geo-index, **double-entry ledger**, live realtime gateways, **330+ endpoints**, **1,200+ tests**, then every client that sits on it — before anyone else touched the code.

02 — STANDARDS BEFORE SCALE

Build it so a team can take over

Idempotent mutations, acyclic module boundaries, migrations that only ever move forward. The whole suite that gates the merge, 3wagger docs, and a shared cron package versioned and pinned to every client — within while I was still the only engineer. That is the difference between a prototype and something you can **hire into**.

03 — FORMS THE COMPANY

Decide what nobody else can decide

Nobody to escalate to when you are the founder and the whole engineering org. I set the stack, formed the company, mapped the live 87,231-ride riding dataset, and set the fares from it — **63% below the daily rate** of Cairo's incumbents (23 fitted rate cards) — a 25% commission, a long trip taper and minimums under every competitor's — each decision run through the business model **before it shipped as a migration**.

04 — THEN LOAN THE TEAM

I have done the other half too

Seven years leading **6+ engineer iOS team** — onboarding, mentoring, reviews, delivery. At **99.6–99.9% crash-free** in production. I know what founding code has to look like for the second engineer entrance, because I have been on the receiving end of it.

§ 02 Professional Experience

Mar 2026 – Present · Riyadh, KSA
Buraq — Founder & CTO
CAIRO → FOUNDER

Founder & CTO — Backend · Web · iOS · Android

buraqsport.com — Buraq Technologies

Founded an Egyptian ride-hailing platform and have carried its **entire technical scope** almost alone: chose the stack, set the standards, and built nine repositories from zero — the backend, the operations console, rider and captain apps on **iOS and Android**, a shared design system for both apps, and the public web app (**buraqsport.com**).

Backend API · NestJS · TypeScript · Mar '26 – now

Modular monolith, **22 modules** in an acyclic graph — **trip state machine**, **scored waterfall dispatch** over a Redis geo-index, admin-tunable pricing, **double-entry ledger** with cent-exact settlement (Payme, Fawry), scheduled and multi-stop rides, real-time **SocketIO gateways**, OTP / Apple / Google auth with RBAC, idempotency on every mutation, **330+ endpoints** over 15 controllers, **1,200+ tests**, 3wagger docs.

Ops Console · Next.js 14 · Jul '26 – now

29-screen ops surface — the **MapLibre** trips map with demand-hardening, dispatch and SOS boards, KYC review, finance reconciliation, refunds and payouts, cash control, role **zone editor**, feature flags, audit log, **Google SSO** · English and Arabic, 170+ texts.

iOS · Rider & Captain · SwiftUI · Swift 5.9 · Jul '26 – now

Two native **SwiftUI** apps on a shared **BuraqCore** package (domain, networking, design system, session primed) — the full **trip lifecycle** on live GPS, SocketIO feeds with REST reconciliation, **offline-first** mutations, **Live Activities**, Siri voice booking, on-device ML transcription, captain earnings and navigation · 240 views, **1,500+ tests**, strict concurrency.

Android · Captain · Kotlin · Jetpack Compose · Aug '26 – now

Native port against **the same API contract** — 18 feature modules on convention plugins, Hilt, a pure-Kotlin domain, onboarding, the shift's foreground service and the trip end to end running against the backend · **1,100+ tests**.

Android · Rider · Kotlin · Jetpack Compose · Sep '26 – now

Screen-by-screen parity port of the iOS rider app — 11 feature modules on a published **buraq-core-android** (GitHub Packages) · **2,200+ tests**, including 371 screenshot goldens in light, dark and RTL.

Web · buraqsport.com · Next.js 14 · React 19 · Jul '26 – now

Marketing site, **rider web app** with live trip tracking, **captain onboarding portal** with on-device document OCR, public trip share pages and app-store deep links (PPR, WCAG 2.2 AA, **1,800+ tests** · **live on Fember since 16 Oct 2026**.

One backend · one contract · six client surfaces — and the company around them: incorporation, the Law 81/2018 license path, a pricing engine fitted to 87,231 observed rides, and launch-and-investor-ready collateral. The live plan, 3,100+ commits, the anchor — so I know exactly what I built to be ready of the team that joins it.

Aug 2019 – Aug 2026 · Riyadh, KSA

iOS Team Lead · 7 years leading the iOS org

Mars — Zahed Group

- **Led a 6+ engineer iOS team** for seven years — onboarding, mentoring, career growth, and the culture bubbles that kept an enterprise POS usable for 20k+ restaurants and cafés.
- **Owned the technical roadmap and architecture**: an offline-first CoreData core with cloud sync, built as a venue keeps trading when the network does not.
- **Set the engineering standards** — modularization, code review, automated testing — that held the app at a 99.6–99.9% crash-free rate in production.
- **Drove the multi-year migration** to SwiftUI, Combine and async/await without pausing feature delivery, and made the case for it to product leadership.
- **Built CI/CD and the release process from scratch**, cutting deployment time 60% and shortening regression cycles from days to hours.
- Ran the performance programme (40% faster load times) and designed the table-management, offline-queueing and inventory systems at the heart of the product.
- Partnered with product, design and backend leadership on scope, estimates and delivery commitments the team could keep.

Dec 2025 – Jun 2026 · Volunteer

Senior iOS Engineer

HarambiTur — Voluntary Charity Project

- Designed the architecture integrating on-device machine learning for real-time content analysis.
- Built a seamless communication layer between native iOS and web-based content.
- Implemented efficient image processing with region-based and full-image blur effects.
- Created a real-time video monitoring system for continuous content filtering.
- Developed smart banner blocking and optimised memory management throughout.

Mar 2018 – May 2019 · Riyadh, KSA

iOS Team Lead

Tgo — The Ride Hailing App

- Led iOS delivery for a complete ride-hailing ecosystem (rider, driver, watchOS) serving 15M+ users in Saudi Arabia.
- Implemented real-time GPS tracking and navigation with MapKit and optimised route algorithms.
- Integrated Apple Pay, HyperPay, and push notification infrastructure.
- Created seamless iPhone ↔ Apple Watch handoff for continuous ride tracking.
- Built the driver rating system and real-time fare calculation engine.

Sep 2016 – Mar 2018 · KSA

Senior iOS Engineer

HungerStation — Delivereasy Group

- Contributed to a major food delivery platform serving 20M+ users.
- Optimized app performance for high-volume transaction processing.
- Implemented real-time order tracking and delivery optimisation.
- Collaborated with backend teams on API design and integration.

May 2016 – Aug 2016

iOS Engineer

AlAqeeh

- Developed food-ordering apps with Firebase integration and real-time features.
- Implemented Spreedly payments and live chat functionality.
- Built responsive UI with Auto Layout across multiple device sizes.

Jul 2015 – Sep 2015

iOS & Apple Watch Developer

Wiza Design Co.

- Early adopter of Apple Watch development (watchOS 1–2).
- Built a foundation in iOS and watchOS app development.
- Adopted Swift4 from WWDC 2019 onward.

May 2014 – May 2015

iOS Developer

Al Pro. Solutions Ltd.

- Foundation iOS experience in Objective-C and early Swift.
- Built social networks and e-commerce platforms.
- Learned core iOS principles and App Store submission.

§ 03 Selected Projects

01 — FULL STACK

Buraq — Ride-Hailing (founded Mar 2026)

NestJS · TypeScript · PostgreSQL · Redis · SwiftUI · Next.js · Kotlin · Jetpack Compose

Egyptian ride-hailing platform I founded and built solo: a hardened NestJS backend by the time anyone else touched it, scored dispatch, double-entry ledger, live realtime gateways, 2,100+ tests, a 29-screen ops console, rider and captain apps on **iOS and Android**, and the public web app **live at buraqsport.com**.

★ Founder & CTO · Nine Repos · 100+ Tests

02 — MOBILITY

Ego — Ride Hailing

Mobile · Core Location · Apple Pay · Push notifs

Complete ride-hailing ecosystem rider app, driver app, and Apple Watch companion. Real-time GPS, Apple Pay, and cross-device synchronization for seamless UX.

★ 4.7 / 5 — 22.8k+ ratings

03 — AI / PRIVACY

HaramBlur — Privacy Browser

SwiftUI · CoreML · WKWebView · Vertexapp · Vision

Privacy-focused iOS browser with real-time, AI-powered content detection and filtering. On-device ML, smart blur effects, and live video monitoring.

• AI-Powered Privacy Browser

04 — ENTERPRISE

Mars — iPad POS

SwiftUI · CoreData · CloudKit · Real-time Sync

Enterprise point-of-sale serving 20k+ restaurants and cafés across Saudi Arabia. Offline-first architecture, table management, real-time order processing — **the product my iOS team owned for seven years.**

★ 4.8 / 5 — 2,417 ratings

04 — ENTERPRISE

HungerStation

iOS14 · Firebase · Real-time MTLs · Perf Optimization

Major food-delivery platform serving 20M+ users across Saudi Arabia and Bahrain. Focused on performance and real-time order tracking.

★ 4.5 / 5 — 1.9M+ ratings

05 — COMMUNITY

Dalcolo

Swift5 · Core Location · Social SDKs · Community

Muslim community app for users across the US — prayer times, mosque finder, and community features with enhanced location and social integration.

★ 4.5 / 5 — 1,287 ratings

§ 04 Stack & Craft

ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP — ORG

Team Leadership · Technical Direction · Architecture Governance · Technical Roadmap · Mentoring & Career Growth · Onboarding · Code Review Culture · Estimation & Planning · Cross-functional Partnership · Quality & Crash Budgets · Release Management · Agile / Scrum

FOUNDER — COMPANY

Company Formation · Pricing & Unit Economics · Business Modelling · Investor Materials · Ride-Hailing Licensing · Payments Vendors · Go-to-Market

I2S — 2025 — CORE

SwiftTLS 0.2 · SwiftTLS · UIKit · Combine · store/small · SwiftData · i2S 18+

ANDROID — 2025 — NATIVE

Kotlin · Jetpack Compose · Coroutines · Flow · MVVM

ARCHITECTURE — PATTERNS

MVVM · VIPER · Clean Architecture · Coordinator · TDD

APPLE ECOSYSTEM — PLATFORMS

watchOS · tvOS · macOS · Widgetkit · Live Activities · App Intents

MODERN FEATURES — INTELLIGENCE

Core ML · Vision · ARKit · Dynamic Island · Charts

BACKEND & APIS — FULL-STACK

NestJS · TypeScript · PostgreSQL · TypeORM · Redis · JWT/OTP Auth · REST · GraphQL · Firebase · CloudKit · Socket.IO · Swagger/OpenAPI · Docker

WEB — FULL-STACK

Next.js 14 · React 19 · Tailwind · MapLibre · Vitest · Playwright · i18n / RTL

TOOLING & AI — WORKFLOW

Xcode 15+ · Fastlane · SPM · Instruments · Git · Claude Code · Codex · Cursor

§ 05 Portfolio Index

FOOD & DINING

HungerStation — delivery
Purbeq — racing tips

TRANSPORTATION

Buraq — founder
Ego — Rider
Ego — Driver
Ego — Watch app

ENTERPRISE

Mars POS
Medical Guide

SOCIAL & COMMUNITY

Dalcolo
MJ Inc
Vasil
Vasil

MATCHES

Ego Watch
TaGo Weather
Tweetlife

E-COMMERCE

iBio
Exclusive Luxe
Scratch

RELIGIOUS & EDU

iMary
ArabiMeGroup

UTILITY & TOOLS

Unlocking Smart
Insta
Contacts
✓ *First iOS app*

AI & ML

HarambiTur — CoreML
Recognizeme
✓ *Great project — OpenCV*

WEB

Fanzilleme
Web Pages

§ 06 Record

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Information Systems

Computer Science College
Ayyat University, Egypt · 2009-2013
100 Semester — Excellent (91.96)

CERTIFICATIONS

ISTQB Foundation Level

Egyptian Software Testing Qualification Board

LANGUAGES

Arabic — Native
English — Professional

§ 07 Honours

01 Led an iOS engineering team for **7 consecutive years** on a POS platform serving **20k+ restaurants** and cafés — through the product's growth from launch scale to enterprise.

02 Held a **99.6–99.9% crash-free rate** and cut deployment time **60%** by building the shared CI/CD, tests and CI/CD the team ran on.

03 Founded Buraq (buraqsport.com), an Egyptian ride-hailing platform, and built all nine repositories solo — backend, ops console, rider and captain apps on iOS and Android, and the public web app, live since Oct 2026 — behind **10,000+ automated tests**.

04 Built a global platform serving **330+ users** across Saudi Arabia and Bahrain, and a ride-hailing ecosystem serving **15M+ users** in Saudi Arabia.

05 **10+ apps** published on the App Store, used by millions across MENA.

06 **30+ projects** delivered across a 12-year career.

07 Early Swift adopter (WWDC 2014), and early SwiftUI adopter (WWDC 2019) — a habit of betting on the right platform shift early.